

## Leafy diet

The koala has a very narrow diet—it eats only the leaves of certain eucalyptus trees. It stores the leaves in its cheek pouches and has an extra-long intestine to help digest them. The koala gets most of its moisture from its food and rarely drinks water—in fact, its name comes from an Aboriginal word meaning “no drink.” The koala can curl its fingers and toes around branches to get a good grip and has claws like knives.



**Koala**  
(*Phascolarctos cinereus*)  
Length: up to 2 ft 8 in (82 cm)

**Queen Alexandra's birdwing butterfly**  
(*Ornithoptera alexandrae*)  
Wingspan: up to 9.8 in (25 cm)



## Biggest butterfly

The Queen Alexandra's birdwing butterfly is the world's largest butterfly. It is now very rare, due to overcollecting and the destruction of the rainforests. This butterfly usually flies high above the ground, where the sun filters through the trees.



**Northern leaf-tailed gecko**  
(*Saltuarius cornutus*)  
Length: up to 9.8 in (25 cm)

**Raggiana bird of paradise**  
(*Paradisaea raggiana*)  
Body length with tail wires: up to 28 in (68 cm)



## Fantastic feathers

The male Raggiana bird of paradise shows off his spectacular feathers to compete against other males and win a female. In contrast, the feathers of the female bird are plain.

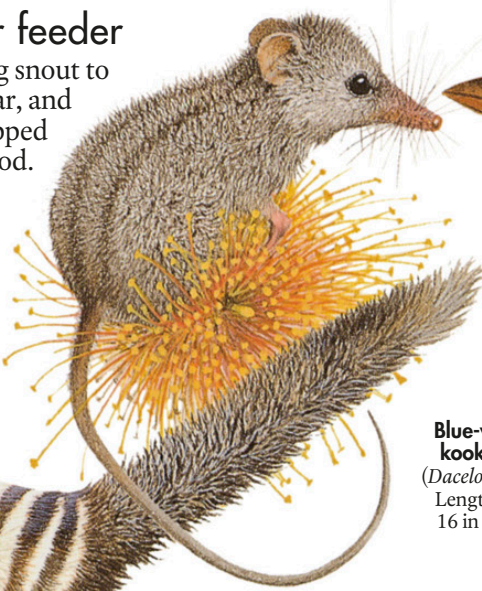
## Invisible animal

During the daytime, the leaf-tailed gecko is perfectly camouflaged against the mossy tree trunks in the rainforests. Its flattened shape also means it casts few shadows.

## Flower feeder

The honey possum uses its long snout to probe into flowers for pollen, nectar, and insects. It has a long, thin tongue tipped with bristles for soaking up its food.

**Honey possum** (*Tarsipes rostratus*)  
Body length: up to 3.5 in (9 cm)



## Toothy mammal

The numbat has a long tongue, which it uses to lick up termites and ants. It has about 50 teeth—among the most of any land mammal.

**Numbat**  
(*Myrmecobius fasciatus*)  
Body length: up to 11.4 in (29 cm)  
Tail: up to 8 in (20.3 cm)



**Blue-winged kookaburra**  
(*Dacelo leachii*)  
Length: up to 16 in (41 cm)

## Alarm clock bird

The kookaburra's noisy cackles, screeches, and barks tell others to keep out of its territory. Kookaburras often call early in the morning, waking people up.

